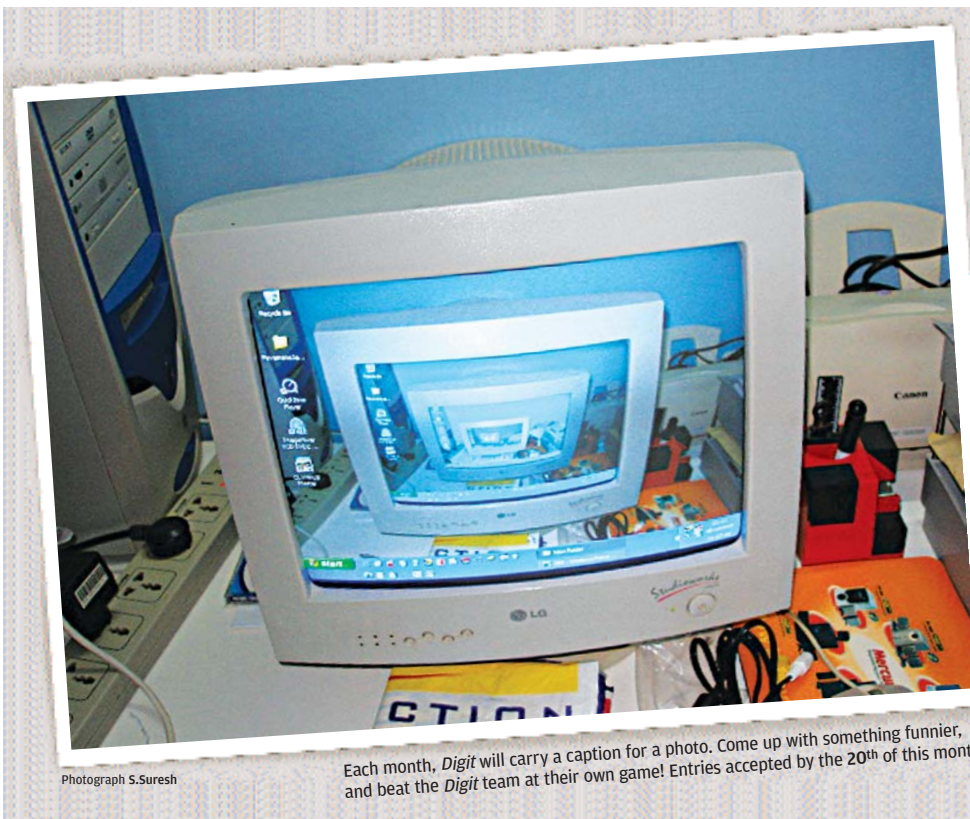




Photograph S.Suresh

Each month, *Digit* will carry a caption for a photo. Come up with something funnier, and beat the *Digit* team at their own game! Entries accepted by the 20th of this month.

Beat That!

Digit Caption

"To Infinity, and beyond!"

Last Month's Winner!

Pratik Dey
Arya Palli
Bhubaneshwar

"Defragment your Future (FREE Scan on demand)"



E-mail your caption with the subject 'Beat That', and your postal address, to beatthat@thinkdigit.com and win

Beginning ActionScript 2.0

by Nathan Derksen & Jeff Berg
Published by

WILEY-INDIA



has decided to take on Intel, citing intellectual property infringement. The claim is that all of Intel's x86-based processor technology, right from *ye olde* days of the Pentium Pro, violates one or more out of ten Transmeta patents. They say that Intel has made over \$100 billion thanks to them, and that they should duly cough up, and foot the legal fees, too.

Among the offending technologies is the power-saving SpeedStep, which is claimed to be a rip-off of Transmeta's "adaptive power control". Other infringements include the famous MMX technology and other hardware design features.

Something, we think, is fishy. The Pentium Pro is but a childhood memory, and it takes Transmeta all these years to realise that it was their technology in the first place? Permit us to scoff. It's interesting to note that Transmeta hasn't been doing all that well for a long time, especially

since they retired from the CPU business around a year ago, choosing instead to go the R&D way. It's still a loss-making enterprise, and no doubt some "financial assistance" from Intel will help things get better.

The devilish plan doesn't end there—even if this ridiculous claim puts Intel in a spot, it'll be cheaper for them to buy Transmeta than pay them off. And what ailing company won't be willing to sell itself to one of the largest corporations in the world? Naughty, naughty!

COUNTING DOWN TO VISTA

Microsoft Relents To Security Vendors

In the run-up to the release of Windows Vista, both Symantec and McAfee haven't hidden

their consternation at the fact that Microsoft had blocked access to the Vista kernel in an attempt to lock out malicious software. The trouble was, they also locked out security software, so any hackers that broke into the kernel would have total control over the OS.

Thankfully, Microsoft has realised the error of its ways and has announced that they will give kernel access to these firms through a set of Application Programming Interfaces (APIs), but only for the 64-bit version of Vista. However, they haven't announced when these APIs will be available, and there have been suggestions that they won't be seen in the January release, causing Symantec to retain its stand.

Says communications director Chris Paden, "If the APIs exist, then Microsoft should make them available to the security industry immediately."

In addition, Microsoft also said that it will modify the Vista Security Center to enable third-party firewalls and anti-spyware tools to send Windows Defender-like alerts to the user.

This comes as a compromise to the security companies' original demands—to let users choose whether they want to replace Security Center completely with third-party software—a demand that Microsoft has expressed no intention to comply with. Whether these new changes will help Vista be more or less secure, remains to be seen.

In the face of the antitrust issues that Microsoft is facing in the EU, we might see more such occurrences in the future. Third party vendors with strong enough arguments will no doubt put intense pressure on the software giant to alter the Windows feature set, and we hope that the ultimate beneficiary of this tug-of-war turns out to be the Vista user.